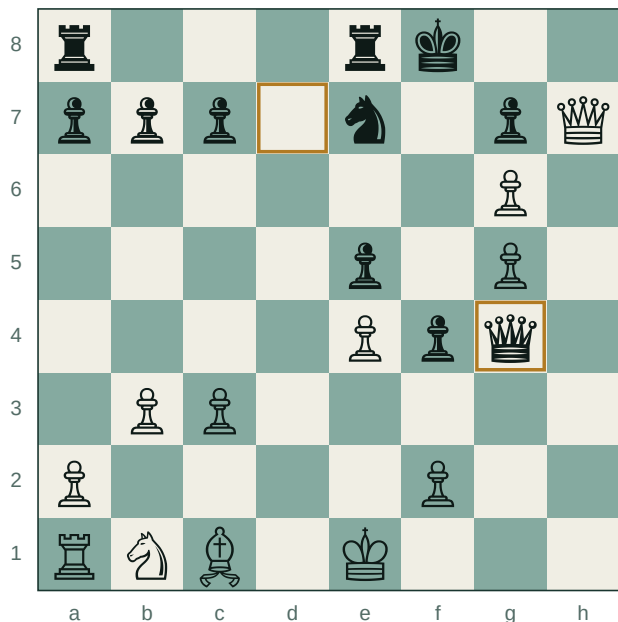


# Pins and pressure: White, move 21

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 20...Qg4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**21. Qh8+ Ng8 22. Ba3+ Re7 23. Bxe7+ Kxe7 24. Qxg7+**

**21.Qh8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **21...Ng8**.

**22.Ba3+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **22...Re7**.

**23.Bxe7+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on e7. Recorded reply: **23...Kxe7**.

**24.Qxg7+** Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From g7 it attacks king on e7 and knight on g8.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

## HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: queen on g4. Check for tactical protection.